# The Landscape of Chinese Renewable Energy Investment Overseas — Q2 2026

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# About this Publication

This report is produced by the International Institute of Green Finance (IIGF) at Central University of Finance and Economics (CUFE), Beijing, China, in collaboration with the Institute of Development Studies (IDS), Brighton, UK. It presents a quarterly update of the D-CORE (Database of Chinese Overseas Renewable Energy Projects), tracking project activities recorded in Q2 2026 (April–June 2026). The findings reflect those of the authors and do not necessarily represent the views of IIGF or IDS.

## Data Note

The D-CORE database currently records 1,512 overseas renewable energy project activities with Chinese involvement, spanning January 2022 to June 2026 and representing about 487 GW of contracted capacity in aggregate. This visible dataset applies to a consistent set of quality filters. It retains only projects with an identifiable primary Chinese entity and, for capacity-based technologies, a valid numeric installed-capacity figure. Each record represents one distinct project with a primary Chinese implementing entity, so that projects with multiple Chinese participants are counted once to avoid double-counting.

This edition focuses on the 101 projects (35.1 GW) whose most recent tracked milestone occurred in Q2 2026. For year-on-year comparison, the corresponding figure for Q2 2025 (April–June 2025) is 116 projects (32.1 GW), drawn from the same filtered dataset. Over the first half of 2026, the database recorded 246 projects (75.4 GW), compared with 223 projects (72.9 GW) in the first half of 2025. Financing-model data, where available, is presented separately and should be interpreted as indicative rather than comprehensive. Because the database is continuously updated and back-filled, quarterly figures reported here may differ slightly from those in earlier editions.

## Key Findings

- **Chinese overseas renewable energy activity remained robust in Q2 2026, though the composition shifted notably.** Project count reached 101, compared with 116 in Q2 2025, while contracted capacity rose from 32.1 GW to 35.1 GW. The capacity increase is largely attributable to a single 8.4 GW renewable energy cluster signed in Ethiopia; net of this record, quarterly capacity was broadly stable relative to a year earlier.
- **Energy storage became the most frequently recorded technology (27 projects), overtaking Solar PV (26 projects).** Dedicated storage deployments nearly doubled year-on-year (from 15 projects in Q2 2025), confirming the acceleration of battery systems in Chinese overseas portfolios. Integrated Energy Solutions recorded the highest contracted capacity (21.4 GW), reflecting the continued rise of bundled generation-plus-storage complexes.
- **Western Asia led all subregions by contracted capacity (10.6 GW across 15 projects), while Southeast Asia led by project count (23 projects).** Uzbekistan recorded the most projects of any host country (8), followed by Vietnam (7) and the Democratic Republic of the Congo (6), indicating a broad geographic base across Central Asia, ASEAN, and sub-Saharan Africa.
- **Engagement in Least Developed Countries (LDCs) expanded from 15 projects in Q2 2025 to 23 in Q2 2026, a 53.3% increase.** Solar PV (13 projects) and Integrated Energy (9 projects) dominated LDC activity, consistent with the deployment of 'solar + storage' solutions in markets with weaker grid infrastructure.
- **The quarter was characterized by a high share of projects reaching completion.** Projects recorded as Operational rose to 30% of the quarterly total, up from 17% in Q1 2026, and 33% of activity are in the completed-plus-operational stage, suggesting that many projects contracted during 2023–2024 are now being commissioned.
- **CEEC and PowerChina continued to dominate delivery in Q2 2026.** At the same time, equipment suppliers and integrated-solution providers gained ground relative to conventional EPC contracting, reflecting the growing weight of module and storage supply in the Chinese actor landscape.

The activity recorded in Q2 2026 continues to unfold within China's broader policy framework for the 15th Five-Year Plan (FYP) period (2026–2030), which identifies the establishment of a clean and efficient new energy system as a core national priority. The Q2 2026 figures offer further empirical signal of momentum aligned with the national agenda of international energy cooperation, particularly with the Global South. In the following analysis, we examine the Q2 2026 projects across technological composition, geographic distribution, developmental stage, financing models, and main actors, and we assess two representative cases in greater depth.

## Technological Composition

The most notable technological development in Q2 2026 was the emergence of Energy Storage as the single most frequently recorded category, with 27 projects, ahead of Solar PV (26 projects). Storage activity nearly doubled relative to Q2 2025 (15 projects), extending the trend documented in previous editions and reflecting accelerating demand for dedicated battery deployments across both commercially mature and grid-constrained markets. Because storage projects are typically sized by energy capacity (MWh) rather than power capacity (MW), they are included in total project counts but excluded from cumulative generation capacity aggregates.

Solar PV, while remaining central to the portfolio, recorded 26 projects (4.3 GW) in Q2 2026, down from 43 projects (13.4 GW) in Q2 2025. Integrated Energy systems (combined generation and storage) recorded 21 projects and the highest contracted capacity of any technology at 21.4 GW, compared with 29 projects (8.3 GW) a year earlier. The elevated capacity figure is driven predominantly by a single 8.4 GW renewable energy cluster signed in Ethiopia; net of this record, Integrated Energy capacity was broadly comparable to the prior year.

Wind Power grew from 14 to 16 projects, with capacity rising from 6.0 GW to 7.7 GW (up 28.3%), supported by continued tendering in Central Asia and East Africa. Hydropower moderated from 12 to 5 projects (1.2 GW), while Biomass expanded from 2 to 4 projects, and Geothermal & Waste Heat remained marginal. Taken together, the quarter confirms that Solar PV and Integrated Energy remain the twin pillars of Chinese overseas renewable engagement, with Energy Storage now firmly established as a fastest-growing third pillar, as measured by deal frequency.

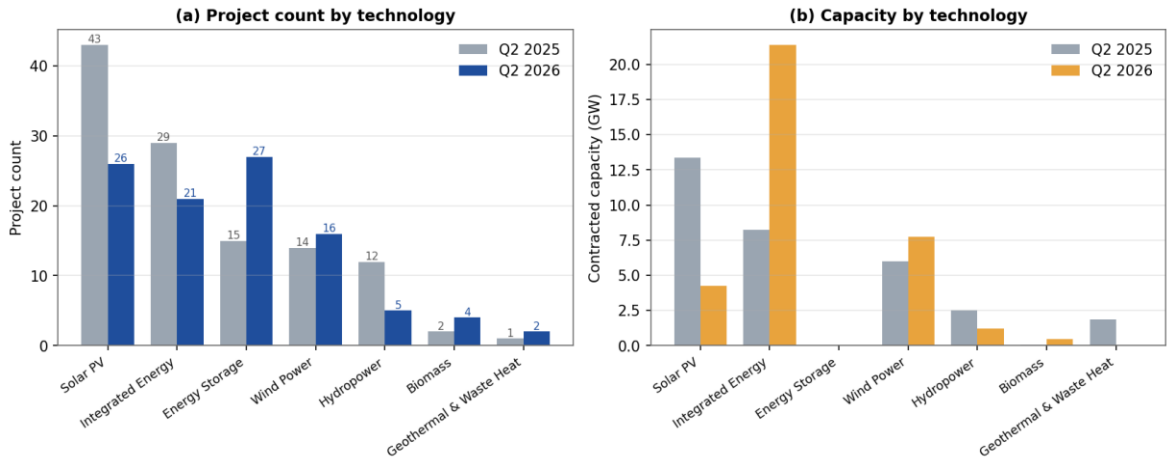



*Figure 1. Chinese overseas renewable energy projects by project count and contracted capacity (GW), Q2 2026 vs Q2 2025*

## Geographic Distribution

Southeast Asia led all subregions by project count in Q2 2026 with 23 projects, though its contracted capacity (5.5 GW) placed it behind Western Asia and Eastern Africa. Vietnam (7 projects), Malaysia (4 projects), Myanmar (5 projects), and Laos (3 projects) drove the region's activity across diverse procurement contexts, with Laos again featuring as a destination for large-scale generation, including the 1,000 MW northern solar base examined below.

Western Asia is dominated by contracted capacity, reaching 10.6 GW across 15 projects, led by the United Arab Emirates (7.3 GW across 3 projects). The scale of individual projects in the Gulf continues to reflect the deployment of large solar and hybrid parks supported by sovereign off-takers and long-term power purchase agreements. Central Asia recorded 14 projects (5.9 GW), with Uzbekistan (8 projects, 3.2 GW) the most active host country in the quarter and Kazakhstan contributing 2.6 GW across 5 projects.

Eastern Africa registered 8.9 GW across 5 projects, a figure almost entirely accounted for by the 8.4 GW Ethiopian renewable energy cluster signed during the quarter. Excluding that single record, Chinese engagement across sub-Saharan Africa in Q2 2026 continued to consist mainly of modestly sized solar, storage, and integrated energy deployments, including several projects in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (6 projects) and Zambia. The majority of these projects are developed to support mining excavation or processing facilities, indicating the emerging trend of mineral-energy nexus in resource rich countries.

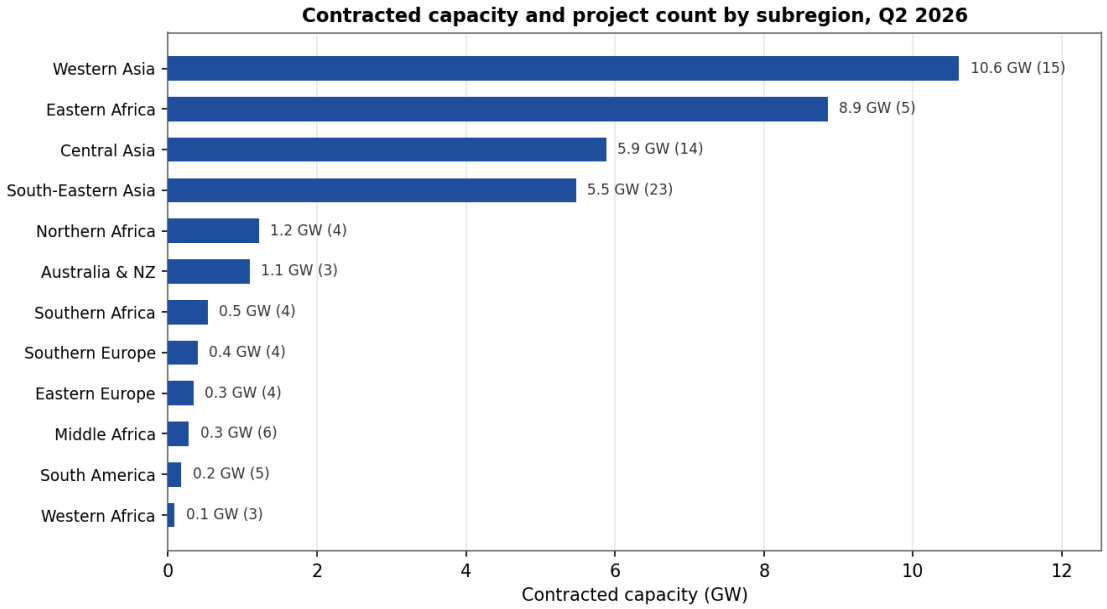



*Figure 2. Contracted capacity (GW) and project count by subregion, Q2 2026*

Among individual host countries, Ethiopia (8.4 GW), the United Arab Emirates (7.3 GW), and Uzbekistan (3.2 GW) led by contracted capacity, while Uzbekistan (8 projects), Vietnam (7 projects), and the Democratic Republic of the Congo (6 projects) led by project count. The divergence between the capacity ranking and the count ranking reflects the coexistence of a small

number of very large Gulf and East African complexes with a broad base of smaller, distributed projects across Asia and Africa.

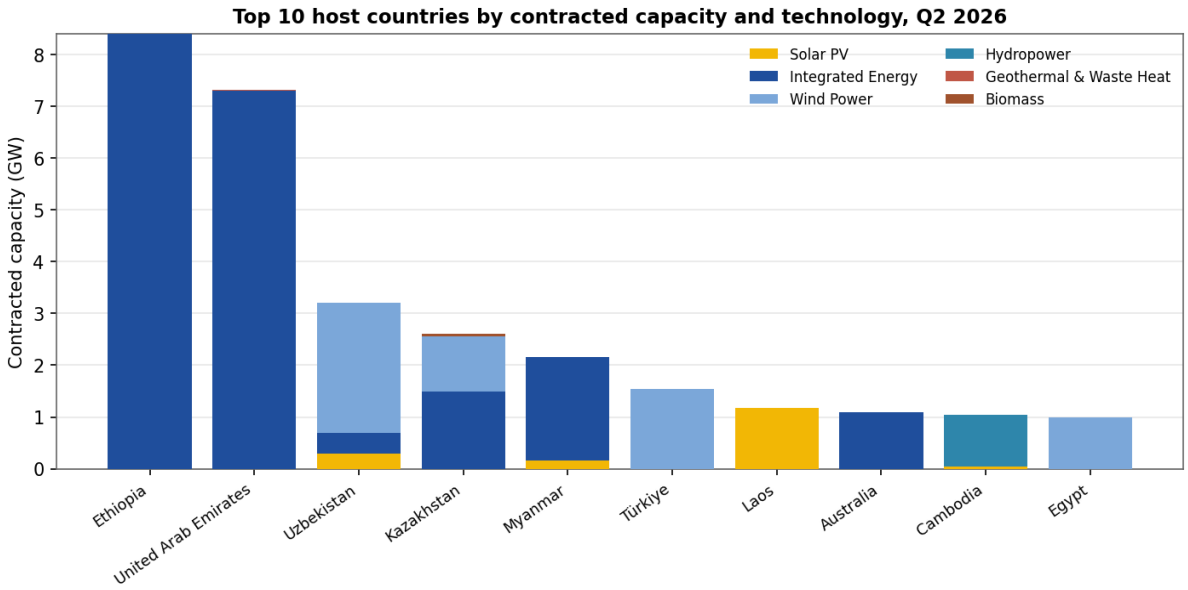



*Figure 3. Top 10 host countries by contracted capacity and technology, Q2 2026*

## Development Stage: LDCs vs. non-LDCs

Of the 101 projects recorded in Q2 2026, 23 were located in Least Developed Countries (LDCs), a marked expansion from 15 LDC projects in Q2 2025 (up 53.3%). The remaining 78 projects were located in non-LDC markets. This continued growth in LDC engagement suggests that Chinese firms are increasingly active in lower-income markets, even as the bulk of contracted capacity remains concentrated in middle-income and high-income contexts.

Solar PV dominated LDC markets, accounting for 13 of 23 LDC projects (56.5%), followed by Integrated Energy (9 projects, 39.1%) and a single hydropower project. The high combined share of solar and integrated systems in LDC contexts is consistent with the deployment of solar-plus-storage solutions in markets with weaker grid infrastructure, including Eritrea, Lesotho, Zambia, and the Democratic Republic of Congo. Notably, all 27 energy storage projects in this period were located in non-LDC markets, indicating that more developed grid environments and commercial off-take structures are required to support dedicated storage investments.

In non-LDC markets, the technology mix was considerably broader, led by Energy Storage (27 projects) and Wind Power (16 projects), followed by Solar PV and Integrated Energy (13 and 12 projects respectively). This differentiation between LDC and non-LDC contexts is broadly consistent with the pattern identified in the previous D-CORE report: Chinese firms adapt their technology supply to host countries' grid readiness and financing environment, with solar and hybrid solutions anchoring the LDC portfolio while more commercially driven markets attract a wider technological mix, including dedicated storage.

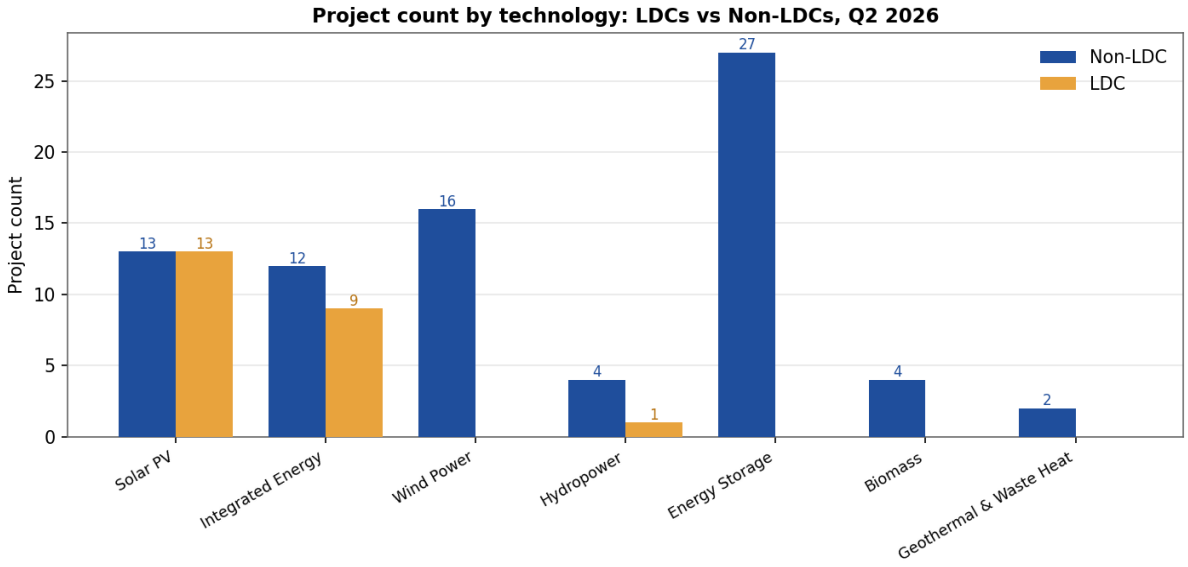



*Figure 4. Project count by technology: LDCs vs. Non-LDCs, Q2 2026*

# Financing Landscape

Financing structures identified for the H1 2026 activity period point to a portfolio in which credit-based and blended arrangements now stand on roughly equal footing, marking the second consecutive half-year in which Chinese policy-bank credit no longer commands a majority share. Of the 246 projects active in H1 2026, 22 (8.9%) carried an identifiable financing model: 10 blended (45%), 9 credit (41%), and 3 equity (14%). Placed alongside the corresponding H1 windows since 2022, this composition represents a marked departure from the pre-2025 pattern in which credit financing consistently accounted for around half or more of identified deals.

The five-year comparison in Figure 5(a) makes the shift explicit. Credit financing dominated H1 2022 (48%), H1 2023 (56%), and H1 2024 (60%), reflecting the traditional model in which Chinese policy banks such as the Export-Import Bank of China and the China Development Bank extend sovereign or concessional loans to host governments or state utilities, with Chinese contractors paid from the loan proceeds. Beginning in H1 2025, blended financing became the leading category for the first time (52% versus 28% for credit), and in H1 2026 the two models are again close to parity, with blended slightly ahead. This trajectory is consistent with the policy guidance under the 'high-quality BRI' agenda encouraging Chinese enterprises to co-finance with multilateral and regional development banks, and with the growing role of MDBs and DFIs as risk-sharing partners in markets where sovereign credit or currency exposure requires additional de-risking. Equity participation has fluctuated within a narrow 13–24% band throughout the five-year period, reflecting the persistent caution of Chinese firms toward long-term balance-sheet exposure in markets with foreign-exchange and regulatory risk.

Underlying these compositional trends is a broader concern about data availability. As shown in Figure 5(b), the share of active projects for which any financing information could be identified rose from 17.4% in H1 2022 to 20.2% in H1 2024, and then declined sharply to 13.0% in H1 2025 and 8.9% in H1 2026. Part of this decline reflects the natural lag between contract award and

financing disclosure, as many of the newly registered projects remain at signing or tendering stage where financial details are not yet public. However, the persistence of the decline into H1 2026 also suggests a broader trend toward more opaque financing arrangements, in which credit is increasingly delivered through Chinese-export-credit-insurance-backed syndicates and packaged internally to central SOEs, leaving fewer publicly traceable signals. As a result, trend readings must be interpreted with growing caution, and each identified deal carries proportionately more analytical weight.

Two H1 2026 cases illustrate the two ends of the current financing spectrum. On the multilateral side, the Kazakhstan 1,000 MW integrated energy project signed in Q2 attracted an A/B loan of USD 548 million from the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development, with the B loan syndicated among China Construction Bank, Qatar National Bank, Société Générale, and Standard Chartered, together with parallel loans of approximately USD 380 million from Proparco, DEG, and the Development Bank of Kazakhstan. This exemplifies the deepening integration of Chinese firms with MDB-led syndicates in large-scale renewable projects. On the credit-driven side, the two Uzbek storage projects signed in the same quarter were financed entirely by a Chinese consortium led by Bank of China Macao and Shenzhen branches, with full underwriting by the China Export & Credit Insurance Corporation (Sinosure), representing the increasingly closed-loop credit model that is likely contributing to the falling disclosure coverage observed above.

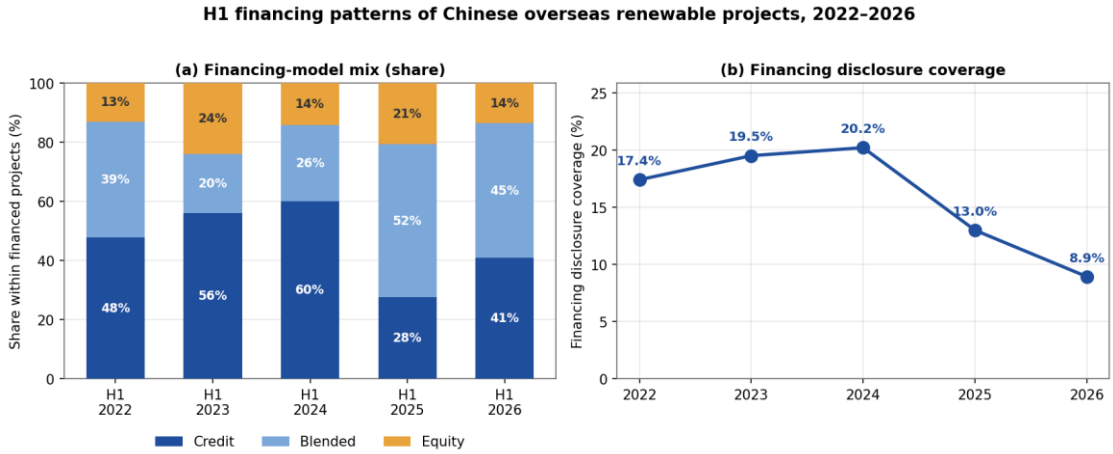



*Figure 5. H1 financing patterns of Chinese overseas renewable projects, 2022–2026: (a) financing-model mix within projects with identified financing; (b) financing disclosure coverage.*

# Key Actors Involved and Project Stages

## Project Stage Distribution

Signed contracts were the most common project stage in Q2 2026 (39% of projects), followed by those recorded as Operational (30%) and Awarded (12%). A notable development in the quarter was the elevated share of projects reaching completion. The Operational share rose from 17% in Q1 2026 to 30% in Q2 2026, and completed-plus-operational projects together accounted for 33% of quarterly activity, compared with 20% in the preceding quarter.

This shift suggests that Q2 2026 functioned in part as a commissioning quarter, in which projects initiated during the 2023–2024 contracting surge reached the grid. Signed and Awarded projects together still accounted for just over half of the quarter's activity, indicating that the forward pipeline remains active even as earlier cohorts are completed.

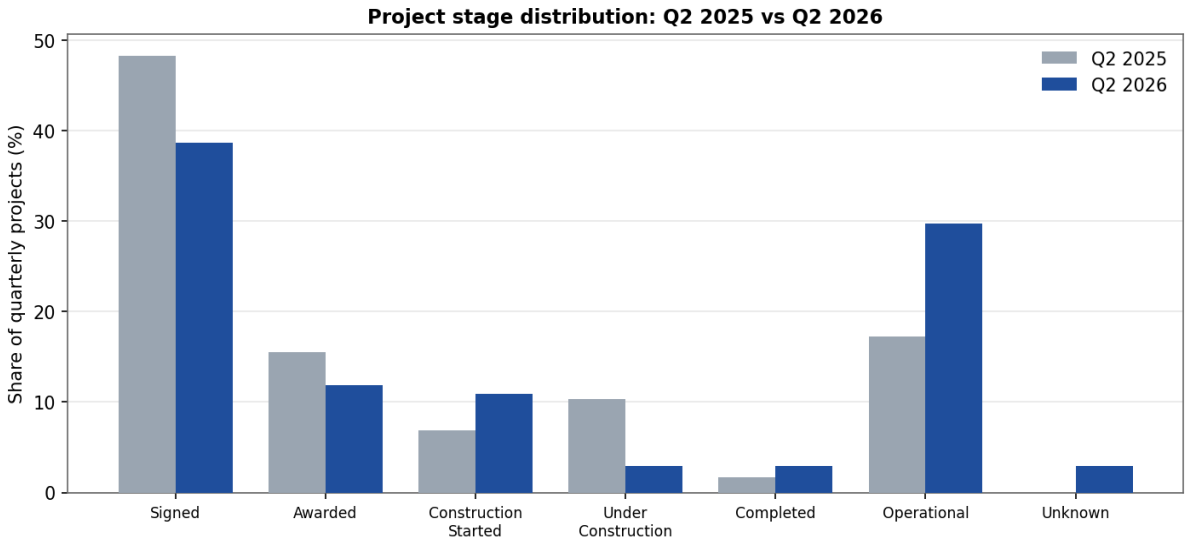



*Figure 6. Project stage distribution: Q2 2025 vs Q2 2026*

## Leading Chinese Companies

CEEC (China Energy Engineering Group) again dominated the quarter, with involvement in 18 projects in Q2 2026, consolidating its position as the leading Chinese firm in overseas renewable energy delivery, particularly across Southeast Asia and Africa. PowerChina followed with 8 projects, and CPECC with 4. Overall, 43 of the 101 projects involved at least one central state-owned enterprise, confirming the continued structural dominance of central SOEs in the delivery of large-scale generation assets.

At the same time, private specialists featured prominently in the equipment- and technology-supply segments. Sungrow and Envision Group each participated in 4 projects, while Goldwind, JinkoSolar, and Suzhou Junhao each appeared in 3, reflecting the rapid growth of Chinese battery storage, wind turbine, and solar module supply in overseas markets. Whereas central SOEs retain structural dominance in construction and investment, the growing footprint of private firms suggests a gradual broadening of the Chinese actor landscape.

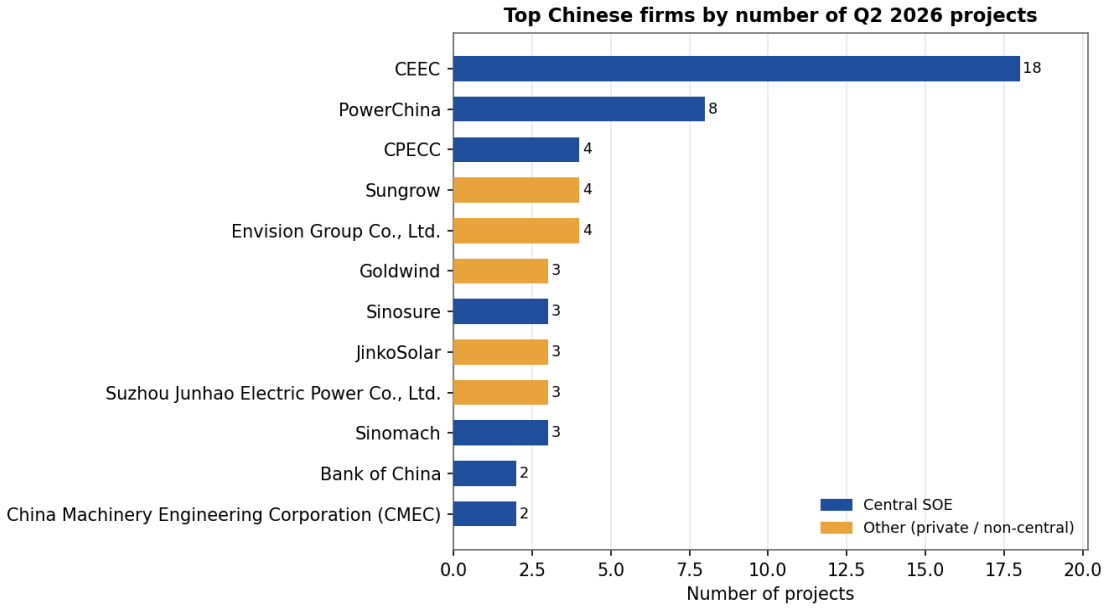



*Figure 7. Top Chinese firms by number of Q2 2026 projects (navy = Central SOE; amber = other)*

The distribution of involvement types reinforces this reading. General EPC contracting remained the single most common role (28% of involvement records), but it was closely matched by Equipment Supply (27%), a considerably tighter margin than in Q2 2025, when EPC contracting alone accounted for 42% of records. Integrated-solution providers (13%) and equity investors (12%) rounded out the principal roles. The relative decline of conventional EPC contracting, together with the rise of equipment supply and integrated-solution provision, is consistent with the technological shift toward storage and modular solar-plus-storage systems. In these configurations, value increasingly accrues to specialized equipment suppliers and system integrators rather than to construction alone.

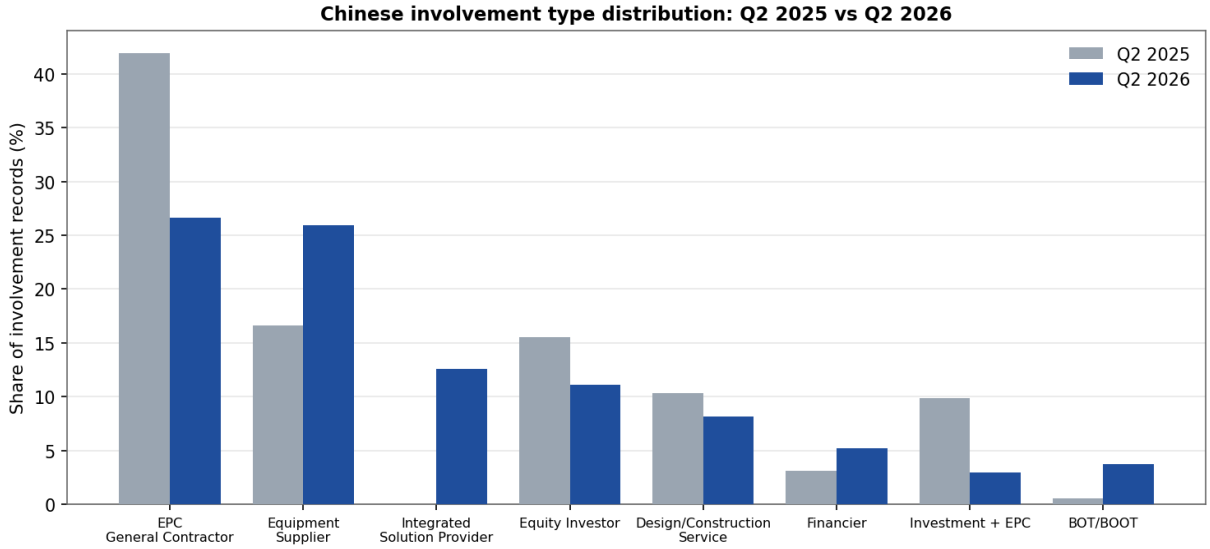



*Figure 8. Chinese involvement type distribution: Q2 2025 vs Q2 2026*

# Representative Projects

To illustrate the delivery models underlying the aggregate figures, we examine two solar projects that reached commercial operation in Q2 2026. The two cases capture the principal contrast in how Chinese firms deliver overseas renewable assets: a full-lifecycle investment-construction-operation model (投建营一体化) in a Southeast Asian market, and a standard division of labor between a central SOE and a private module supplier in a North African market. The Laos project adds a utility-scale solar asset to a national power system historically dominated by large hydropower and positions the country as an emerging node in regional cross-border renewable energy trade, while the Algeria project is the first operational milestone under Algeria's national 3 GW solar program, marking the country's first tangible step away from near-total reliance on natural-gas-fired power generation.

## Laos Northern Interconnection Clean Energy Base Phase I — 1GW Solar PV



Source: CEEC Yunnan Institute

### Executive Overview

The Northern Interconnection Clean Energy Base (Phase I), located in Oudomxay Province in northern Laos, is the largest single-capacity solar PV project in Laos and among the largest in Southeast Asia. With an installed capacity of 1,000 MW, the project was developed under an investment-led framework by Chinese central SOEs and was connected to the grid on 7 April 2026. It exemplifies the investment-construction-operation integration model that Chinese power enterprises are increasingly adopting overseas. Under this model, a firm shifts from a pure EPC role to a full-lifecycle investor and operator, securing long-term cash flows while deepening its participation in the host country's energy system. For Laos, whose electricity generation has long been dominated by large hydropower and remains exposed to the seasonal and climate-related vulnerabilities of a mono-source system, the project adds a utility-scale solar asset to the national

clean-energy portfolio and further positions Laos as an emerging node in regional cross-border renewable energy trade. Laos is currently classified as a Least Developed Country and is scheduled to graduate from LDC status on 24 November 2026, which places this project within the closing window of Chinese LDC-market engagement in the country under the pre-graduation regime.

**Investment and Stakeholder Structure**

The project was led by China General Nuclear Power Group (CGN), which acts as investor and long-term operator under a BOT/BOOT arrangement, while China Power Engineering Consulting Group (CPECC), a subsidiary of China Energy Engineering Group (CEEC), served as the EPC general contractor. China Southern Power Grid (CSG) is associated with the cross-border power interconnection that allows electricity generated in northern Laos to be transmitted to Yunnan Province in China, positioning the project within the broader China-Laos power interconnection agenda rather than as a purely domestic supply asset.

**Financing**

The project's financing structure is designed in a way that largely insulates it from Lao sovereign credit and currency risk. Under the BOT/BOOT arrangement, China General Nuclear Power Group (CGN) owns and operates the asset, and the electricity is transmitted across the border to China Southern Power Grid (CSG) in Yunnan Province rather than sold to the Laotian state utility, so the revenue stream depends on a Chinese state-grid off-taker denominated outside the local kip. Construction-phase green bridge financing was provided by DBS Bank through its China and Hong Kong entities, a Singapore-headquartered commercial lender rather than a Chinese policy bank. Together, these features enable the project to reach commercial scale and attract international commercial financing in a market that would otherwise present significant sovereign-credit and foreign-exchange constraints — a structure that has become increasingly common for large Chinese-led renewable projects in LDC and low-income markets.

**Development Timeline and Operational Status**

The project progressed from award of the EPC contract in December 2023, through construction commencement in December 2024 and the associated financing arrangement in early 2025, to full grid connection in April 2026. The relatively compressed construction period reflects the execution efficiency associated with integrated investment-construction ownership and standardized Chinese solar supply chains. As the largest single-capacity solar project in Southeast Asia to reach operation in the quarter, it stands as a clear example of the investment-led model in an LDC context, made bankable by an established cross-border off-take arrangement with the Chinese grid rather than by any local sovereign credit assumption.

## Algeria Biskra 220 MW Solar PV Project



Source: POWERCHINA

### Executive Overview

The Biskra 220 MW solar PV plant, located in Biskra Province in eastern Algeria, was the first project to enter commercial operation within Algeria's 3 GW national solar program, reaching grid connection in April 2026. The project is representative of the most common delivery structure in the Chinese overseas renewable portfolio, in which a central SOE undertakes the EPC contract while a private Chinese manufacturer supplies the solar modules. It is expected to generate approximately 400 GWh of clean electricity per year for the Algerian grid. As the first project to enter commercial operation under Algeria's national 3 GW solar program, Biskra represents the first tangible operational milestone in Algeria's energy transition away from near-total dependence on natural gas for power generation.

### Stakeholder and Technical Framework

PowerChina served as the general EPC contractor, delivering the plant through its municipal and North Africa engineering units, while CHINT, a private Chinese manufacturer, supplied the photovoltaic modules under a separate procurement award. This division of labor, with a central SOE responsible for engineering, procurement, and construction and a private firm providing the core generation equipment, is characteristic of a large share of Chinese overseas solar projects. It reflects the complementary strengths of state-owned contractors and private-sector equipment suppliers within the Chinese renewable value chain.

### Development Timeline

The project advanced from contract signature in March 2024, through construction commencement in April 2024 and the module procurement award in September 2024, to

commercial operation in April 2026, in line with the roughly 16-month construction schedule announced at signing. As the first operational project within Algeria's larger solar program, Biskra provides an early indication of the delivery capability that Chinese contractors and manufacturers bring to North African markets pursuing large-scale energy transition plans.

## Conclusion

The Q2 2026 data reveal a portfolio that is maturing in both energy mix and project delivery. Three structural signals stand out.

First, the technological center of gravity is shifting. Energy Storage became the most frequently recorded technology in the quarter, and integrated solar-plus-storage systems accounted for the largest share of contracted capacity. Together with the relative decline of pure EPC contracting in favor of equipment supply and integrated-solution provision, this indicates that value in the Chinese overseas renewable portfolio is increasingly concentrated in modular, storage-enabled systems and in the specialized firms that supply them.

Second, the portfolio's developmental impact continues to broaden. Engagement in Least Developed Countries grew by more than half, with solar PV and integrated energy anchoring activity in markets with weaker grid infrastructure. At the same time, dedicated storage remained concentrated in non-LDC markets with more developed grids and commercial off-take structures, underscoring that Chinese firms continue to adapt their technology supply to host-country conditions.

Third, the quarter functioned in part as a commissioning period, with the share of operational and completed projects rising sharply relative to the preceding quarter. This suggests that projects contracted during the 2023–2024 pipeline expansion are now reaching the operational stage, and it underscores the growing importance of monitoring the transition from contracting to commissioning and the financing structures that underpin it in assessing the real-world impact of Chinese overseas renewable investment in the Global South.

Beneath the aggregate landscape lie distinct delivery models. The Laos northern solar base exemplifies investment-led, full-lifecycle participation. The Biskra project in Algeria represents the more standard division of labor between a central-SOE EPC contractor and a private module supplier. Both models reached commercial operation in Q2 2026, and the coexistence of investment-led and construction-led approaches will remain central to understanding how Chinese firms deliver renewable capacity across markets of differing risk and grid maturity. As subsequent quarters are added, sustained attention to whether strong contracting activity translates into equivalent capacity delivery and to the resilience of this activity amid regional geopolitical uncertainty will be essential for interpreting the trajectory of Chinese overseas renewable energy investment.